How to read a spec sheet.

The five figures worth checking before you sign off a window.

The five figures

Check these first.

/01 **Design pressure**

Wind load the window is rated for, in psf. Higher is stronger.

/02 **U-factor**

Heat through the whole window. Lower is better.

/03 **STC**

Sound blocked. Higher is quieter.

/04 **Air infiltration**

Air leaking through, in cfm/ft². Lower is tighter.

/05 **Water resistance**

Pressure before water gets in, in psf. Higher is better.

An example

Vista Guard, on paper.

Design pressure

±65 psf

Air infiltration

0.002 cfm/ft²

Water resistance

15 psf

Impact

Wind Zone 4

Approval

HVHZ



And one more

On the coast, check impact.

/01 Large or small missile.

/02 Wind Zone rating.

/03 Approved inside or outside the HVHZ.

Look for

Florida Product Approval or NOA

Save this

Five numbers, one decision.

Send us any spec sheet and we will walk you through it.

Which number do you check first? Tell us in the comments.

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